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DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

CSE0001: Project Report

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Introduction

This project serves as a comprehensive exploration of digital literacy in the modern academic and professional landscape. As a Computer Science student, the transition from being a passive consumer of technology to an active, secure, and professional digital citizen is vital. This report documents a five-task journey: creating a digital infographic, establishing a professional presence on platforms like GitHub and Kaggle, demonstrating cloud-based collaboration through Google Forms and HackerRank, mastering professional email etiquette, and researching cybercrime scenarios. The primary objective was to build a structured digital workflow while maintaining a secure and professional online identity that aligns with the standards of a CSE professional.

Task 1 Write-up

For Task 1, I designed a professional digital guide titled "Level Up Your Digital Game: A Guide for the Modern Engineering Student." I used **Canva** to create a high-quality infographic focusing on three core pillars: Cloud Collaboration, Cybersecurity, and Professional Networking. The goal was to provide a visual roadmap for peers to manage their digital lives. **Reflection:** This task was a lesson in information hierarchy. I realized that presenting technical advice (like using Password Managers) is more effective when combined with clean design and concise language. It improved my ability to simplify complex cybersecurity concepts for a broader student audience.

Task 2 Write-up

In Task 2, I established a professional digital presence across three industry-standard platforms: **GitHub, Kaggle, and Stack Overflow.**

- **GitHub:** Acts as my primary repository for code and project documentation.
- **Kaggle:** Provides a space for me to practice data science and compete in machine learning challenges.
- **Stack Overflow:** Allows me to engage with the developer community by solving technical bugs and learning from senior engineers. **Future Plans:** Moving forward, I plan to use these platforms to host my "EcoWatt AI" project and other CSE Core assignments. These profiles are not just for class; they are my living resume that will eventually show recruiters my growth as a developer over the next four years.

Task 3 Write-up

Task 3 focused on demonstrating technical skills through cloud-based platforms. I used **HackerRank** to complete a Python logic challenge involving conditional statements, which is a fundamental skill in my CSE curriculum. Additionally, I utilized **Google Forms** to create a "Digital Literacy Assessment Quiz" featuring automated logic and response tracking. **Platform Usage:** By combining a coding platform with a collaboration tool, I practiced the dual nature of

modern engineering: technical execution and data collection. Building the quiz taught me how to structure questions to minimize user error, while the HackerRank challenge reinforced my comfort with Python syntax under a timed environment.

Task 4 Write-up

For Task 4, I drafted a professional email requesting an assignment extension from a professor.

Communication Scenario: I focused on a situation where a technical failure (workstation crash) necessitated a request for extra time. I ensured the email had a clear subject line, a formal salutation, a valid explanation, and a proposed new deadline. **Key Learnings:** The most important learning was the "Three-Point Rule" of professional emails: identify yourself immediately, state the problem clearly, and offer a specific solution. This ensures that the recipient has all the information needed to make a decision without unnecessary back-and-forth communication.

Task 5 Write-up

Researching the UPI "Request Money" scam surprised me because of how low-tech the execution is compared to the high financial impact. I discovered that scammers rely more on psychological pressure (social engineering) than on actual hacking. Most victims are tricked simply because they don't realize a PIN is only for sending money, not receiving it. **Habit Change:** As a result, I have adopted the "Three-Second Rule." Before entering a PIN or scanning any QR code, I will pause for three seconds to verify if the transaction is a "Debit" or "Credit." This habit ensures that I am never rushed into a mistake by an attacker's artificial sense of urgency.

Conclusion

The CSE0001 project has been an essential bridge between my technical studies and my professional identity. I have learned that digital literacy is not just about knowing how to use software, but about knowing how to use it safely, professionally, and collaboratively. From version control on GitHub to understanding UPI fraud in India, these skills have prepared me for the responsibilities of being a CSE Core student. I now feel confident in my ability to manage a professional portfolio and navigate the digital landscape with a security-first mindset.

References

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